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Shakta pithas

The **Shakta pithas**, also called **Shakti pithas** or **Sati pithas** (Sanskrit: शाक्त पीठ, *Śakta Pīṭha*, *seats of Devi Sati*[1]), are significant shrines and pilgrimage destinations in Shaktism, the mother goddess denomination in Hinduism. The shrines are dedicated to various forms of Adi Shakti.[a] Various Puranas such as Srimad Devi Bhagavatam state the existence of a varying number of 51, 52, 64 and 108 Shakta pithas[2][3] of which 18 are named as Astadasha *Maha* (major) and 4 are named as Chatasrah *Aadi* (first) in medieval Hindu texts. (Devanagari: चतस्रः आदि)[2]

Legends abound about how the Shakta pithas came into existence. The most popular is based on the story of the death of Sati, a deity according to Hinduism. Shiva carried Sati's body, reminiscing about their moments as a couple, and roamed around the universe with it. Vishnu cut her body into 51 body parts, using his Sudarshana Chakra, which fell on earth to become sacred sites where all the people can pay homage to the goddess. To complete this task, Shiva took the form of Bhairava.

Shri Mata Vaishno Devi Temple is one of the 64 and 108 Maha (Major) Shakta pithas and is also the most visited among all. It attracts more than 15 million people annually.[4]

Most of these historic places of goddess worship are in India, but there are some in Nepal, seven in Bangladesh, two in Pakistan, and one each in Tibet, Sri Lanka[3] and Bhutan.[6] There were many legends in ancient and modern sources that document this evidence. A consensus view on the number and location of the precise sites where goddess Sati's corpse fell is lacking, although certain sites are more well-regarded than others.

The greatest number of Shakta pithas are present in the Bengal region. During partition the numbers were West Bengal (19,) and Bangladesh (7). After the secret transfer of Dhakeshwari Shakta pitha from Dhaka to Kolkata the numbers stand as West Bengal (20,) and Bangladesh (6).

Hinduism

Shri Hinglaj Mata temple Shakta pitha is the largest Hindu pilgrimage centre in Pakistan. The annual Hinglaj Yatra is attended by more than 250,000 people.[5]

Hindu literature

The Brahmanda Purana, one of the major eighteen Puranas mentions 64 Shakta pithas of the goddess Parvati in the Bharat or Greater India including present-day India, Bhutan, Bangladesh, Nepal, Sri Lanka, some parts of Southern Tibet in China and parts of southern Pakistan. Another text which gives a listing of these shrines, is the *Shakta pitha stotram*, written by Adi Shankara, the 9th-century Hindu philosopher.[7]

According to the manuscript *Mahapithapurana* (c. 1690–1720 CE), there are 52 such places. Among them, 23 are located in the Bengal region, 14 of these are located in what is now West Bengal, India, 1 in Baster (Chhattisgarh), while 7 are in what is now Bangladesh.

Shakambhari Shakta pitha, Saharanpur, Uttar Pradesh. Shakambhari Devi is one of the 108 Siddha pithas of Brahma Purana and one of the oldest temples of Devi Shakambhari. Around ten million people visit the temple annually.

Daksha yajna

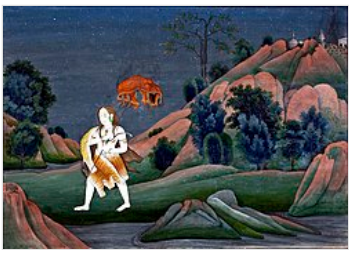
According to legend, lord Brahma once conducted a huge yajna (ritual sacrifice), where all the prajapatis, deities, and kings of the world were invited. Shiva and Sati were also called on to participate in the yajna. All of them came for the yajna, and sat in the ceremonial place. Daksha came last. When he arrived, everyone in the yajna, with the exception of Brahma and Shiva, stood up, showing their reverence for him.[8] Brahma, being Daksha's father, did not rise. Shiva, being Daksha's son-in-law, and also because he is superior in stature to Daksha, remained seated. Daksha misunderstood Shiva's gesture, and considered this act an insult. Daksha vowed to take revenge on the insult in the same manner.[9]

Daksha performed a yajna with a desire to take revenge on Shiva. Daksha invited all the deities to the yajna, except Shiva and Sati. The fact that she was not invited did not deter Sati's desire to attend the yajna. She expressed her desire to Shiva, who tried his best to dissuade her from going. He relented at her continued insistence, Sati went to her father's yajna. However, Sati was not given her due respect at the yajna, and had to bear witness to Daksha's insults aimed at Shiva. Anguished, Sati cursed her father and self-immolated.

Enraged at the insult and death of his spouse, Shiva in his Virabhadra avatar destroyed Daksha's yajna and cut off his head. His anger not abated and immersed in grief, Shiva then picked up the remains of Sati's body and performed the Tandava, the celestial dance of destruction, across all creation. Frightened, the other deities requested Vishnu to intervene to stop this destruction. As a recourse, Vishnu used the Sudarshana Chakra on Sati's corpse. This caused various parts of Sati's body to fall at several spots across the world.[10]

The history of Daksha yajna and Sati's self-immolation had immense significance in shaping the ancient Sanskrit literature and influenced the culture of India. Each of the places on Earth where Sati's body parts were known to have fallen were then considered as Shakta pithas and were deemed places of great spiritual importance.[11] Several stories in the Puranas and other Hindu religious books refer to the Daksha yajna. It is an

important incident in both Shaivism and Shaktism, and marks the replacement of Sati with Parvati, and of the beginning of Shiva's house-holder (*grihastāshramī*) life from an ascetic. This event is ahead of the emergence of both of the couple's children, Kartikeya and Ganesha.[12]

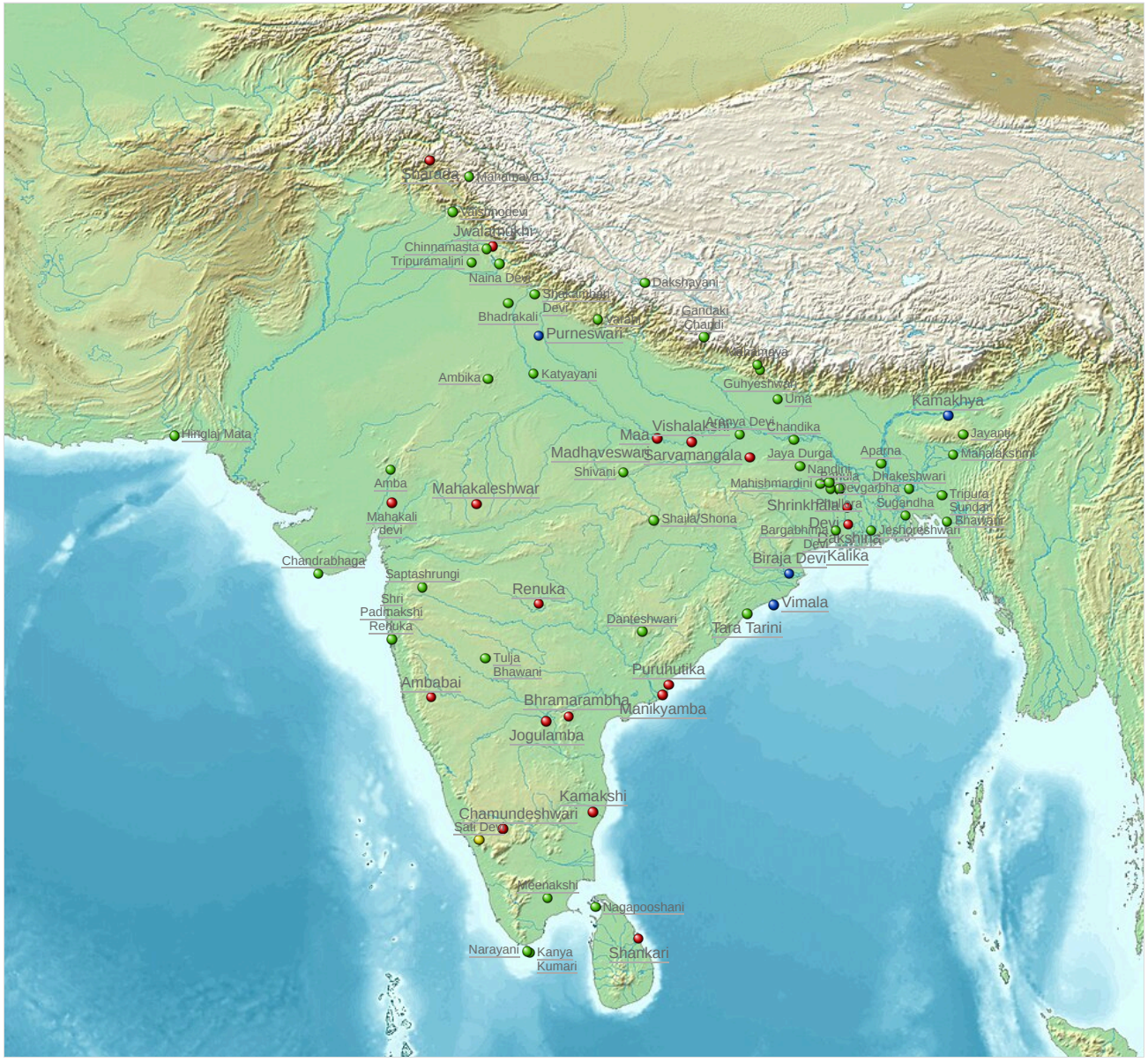


Shiva carrying the corpse of Dakshayani

Shakta pithas

Each temple has shrines for Shakti and Kalabhairava, and most Shakti and Kalabhairava in different Shakta pithas have different names.

Map of India's Shakta pithas



Shakti names at locations of Shakta pithas

Blue: Adi Shakta pithas; Red: Ashtadasha Maha Shakta pithas; Yellow: Daksha yagna site; Green: Maha Shakta pithas

List of 4 Adi Shakta pithas

The scriptures, which include the Kalika Purana, recognize four Shakta pithas as sites where most of the energy is. The first pitha is Odra (Biraja and Vimala) where the pair of feet fell along with pair of thights , the second pitha is Jalasaila (Chandi) where the pair of breasts fell, the third pitha is Purnagiri (Purneswari) where the arms along with the neck fell, and the fourth is Kamrupa (Kamakhaya) where the yoni fell. These four places originated from the lifeless body of Devi Sati.

Apart from these 4 there are 48 other famous pithas recognized by religious texts. According to the *Pithanirnaya Tantra* the 51 pithas are in the present day countries of India, Sri Lanka, Bangladesh, Nepal, Tibet, Bhutan and Pakistan. The *Shivacharita* besides listing 51 maha-pithas, speaks about 26 more upa-pithas. The Bengali almanac, Vishuddha Siddhanta Panjika too describes the 51 pithas including the present modified addresses. A few of the several accepted listings are given below.[13] In South India, Srisailam in Andhra Pradesh became the site for a 2nd-century temple.[14]

List of 18 Ashtadasha Maha Shakta pithas

There are believed to be 64 locations. Adi Shankara's *Ashtadasha Shakta pitha stotram* mentions 18 locations known as the *Maha Shakta pithas*. Among these, the Shakta pithas at Kamakhya, Gaya and Ujjain are regarded as the most sacred as they symbolize the three most important aspects of the Mother Goddess viz. Creation (Kamarupa Devi), Nourishment (Sarvamangala Devi/Mangalagauri), and Annihilation (Mahakali Devi).

Sr. No.	Temple	Place	State in India/Country	Appellation	Part of the body fallen	Shakti	Image
1	Historically unknown Recent claims : Koneswaram Temple (no Devi shrine)	*Lanka* Historically undetermined Recent claims : Trincomalee (Thirukonamalai)	Sri Lanka	Shankari Pitham	Groin	Goddess Shankari	
2	Kamakshi Amman Temple	Kanchipuram	Tamil Nadu	Kamakoti Pitham	Navel	Goddess Kamakshi	
3	Shrinkala Temple	Pradmunyee(Pandua)	West Bengal	Bhavatārini Pitham	Part of stomach	Goddess Shrinkhala	
4	Chamundeshwari Temple	Mysuru	Karnataka	Krouncha Pitham	Hair	Goddess Chamundeshwari	
5	Jogulamba Devi	Alampuram	Telangana	Yogini Pitham	Teeth	Goddess Jogulamba (Yogamba Thalli)	
6	Bhramaramba Mallikarjuna Temple	Srisailam	Andhra Pradesh	Srisaila Pitham	Neck	Goddess Bhramarambika	
7	Mahalakshmi Temple	Kolhapur	Maharashtra	Shri Pitham	eye	Goddess Mahalakshmi (Aai Ambabai Devi)	
8	Renuka	Mahur	Maharashtra	Moola Pitham	Left hand	Goddess Renuka	
9	Mahakaleswar Temple	Ujjain	Madhya Pradesh	Ujjaini Pitham	Upper lip	Goddess Mahakali	
10	Kukkuteswara Swamy Temple	Pithapuram	Andhra Pradesh	Pushkarini Pitham	Back	Goddess Puruhutika	
11	Biraja Temple	Jajpur	Odisha	Oddyana Pitham	Part of abdomen	Goddess Biraja	

12	Bhimeswara Temple	Draksharamam	Andhra Pradesh	Daksharama Pitham	Left cheek	Goddess Manikyamba	
13	Kamakhya Temple	Guwahati	Assam	Kamarupa Pitham	Genitals	Goddess Kamakhya	
14	Alopi Devi Mandir	Prayagraj	Uttar Pradesh	Prayaga Pitham	Fingers	Goddess Madhaveshwari	
15	Jwalamukhi Temple	Jwalamukhi	Himachal Pradesh	Jwalamukhi Pitham	Tongue	Goddess Jwala	
16	Mangla Gauri Temple	Gaya	Bihar	Gaya Pitham	Breast	Goddess Sarvamangala	
17	Vishalakshi Temple	Varanasi	Uttar Pradesh	Varanasi Pitham	Earrings	Goddess Vishalakshi	
18	Sharada Peeth	Sharda	Pakistan	Sharada Pitham	Right hand	Goddess Sharada	

Sharadha pitha is currently in a ruined state.[15] Only ruins are found in these places. Its ruins are near the Line of Control (LOC)[16] between the Indian and Pakistani-controlled portions of the former princely state of Kashmir and Jammu. Instead, Sringeri Sharada pitham, Sringeri in Karnataka even though not a Shakta pithas, is this aspect of the goddess. It is believed that Goddess Sharada moved from her ruined temple in Kashmir to live in the new temple in Sringeri. Requests have been made by the Hindu community in Pakistan to the Pakistani government to renovate the temple, the issue being raised by former Indian Home minister L. K. Advani to the Pakistan authorities[17] as a confidence-building measure, by increasing the people-to-people cross-border interaction.[16]

Currently, a new Sharada pitha temple has been inaugurated and consecrated by the Indian Government and the Sringeri Sharada Peetham in 2023, in Kupwara district, Jammu and Kashmir, on the other side of the LOC and much farther from the original temple. The Indian Government is planning an international corridor between the old Sharada pitha and India.

In Skanda Purana

As per Sankara Samhita of Skanda Purana,[18]

1. Sri Sankari Pitham (Sri Lanka)
2. Sri Simhika Pitham (Simhala)
3. Sri Manika Pitham (Draksharamam, Dakshavati)
4. Sri Shadkala Pitham (Peethapuram)

5. Sri Bhramaramba Pitham (Srisailam)
6. Sri Vijaya Pitham (Vijayapura)
7. Sri Mahalakshmi Pitham (Kolhapur)
8. Sri padmakshi renuka Pitham (Mahurgad)
9. Sri Kamakoti Pitham (Kanchipuram)
10. Sri Kuchananda Pitham (Salagrama)
11. Sri Biraja Pitham (Jajpur)
12. Sri Bhadreshwari Pitham (Harmyagiri)
13. Sri Mahakali Pitham (Ujjain)
14. Sri Vindhyavasini Pitham (Vindhya mountains)
15. Sri Mahayogi Pitham (Ahicchatra)
16. Sri Kanyaka Pitham (Kanyakumari)
17. Sri Vishalakshi Pitham (Varanasi)
18. Sri Saraswati Pitham (Kashmir)
19. Sri Ugratara Shakta pitha (Saharsa)
20. Sri Abhirami Pitham (Padmagiri, Dindigul)

List of all Shakta pithas

In the listings[19][20][21][22] below:

- "Shakti" refers to the Goddess worshipped at each location, all being manifestations of Goddess Sati; later known as Parvati or Durga;
- "Bhairava" refers to the corresponding consort, each a manifestation of Shiva;
- "Body Part or Ornament" refers to the body part or piece of jewellery that fell to earth, at the location on which the respective temple is built.

More details on this are available in the text 'Tantrachūḍamanī'[23] where Parvati tells these details to her son Skanda.

Important notes:

- The Guhyeshwari temple should not be confused with the Shakta pitha mentioned in the *Peethanirnaya* from *Tantra Chudamani*, where Sati's both knees are said to have fallen in Nepal and the presiding deity is Mahamaya. According to the *Nepal Mahatmya* 11.107 and 1.38, Sati's both knees fell near the confluence of the Vishnumati and Bagmati rivers, where the presiding deity is Mahamaya, while the Anus fell near the Bagmati river close to the Mrigasthali of the Pashupati temple, and the deity is Guhyeshwari or Guhyakali.[24]

- The main idol of the Dhakeshwari Shakta pitha in Bangladesh is currently relocated to the Kumartuli Dhakeshwari Temple in Kolkata, West Bengal. The temple priest fled to India with the main idol during the partition via a specially chartered train. While in the original shrine, a replica is placed. The original holy gem of Goddess Sati was lost long before (the factual date is unknown). So for the actual idol, visit the Kumartoli shrine.

- The Shrinkhala Shakta pitha (one of 18 Maha Shakta pithas) in Hooghly, West Bengal, is a disputed site. The original shrine was destroyed during the Bengal Sultanate and an Islamic Minar was built there by the Muslims. Years later, a door claimed by the locals as the door to the sanctum of the temple is closed by the ASI. The Hindus claim that the temple was destroyed and the minar was built there. It is claimed that the idol of Goddess Shrinkhala was taken to Sringeri in Karnataka but no such evidence exists there to date because a different Sharada Devi Temple was built there by Adi Shankaracharya. At present in the Hooghly district, only the Ratnabali Shakta pith is present.

- Confusion about Hingalaj Bhawani Temple: it is said the main deity was secretly shifted to Talcher, Odisha in the medieval era by the then Maharajah of Talcher Princely State, where she is in the form of Hingula Debi.

Sr. No.	Place	State in India/Country	Body part or ornament	Shakti	Bhairava	Image
1	**A**. Amarnath Temple, from Srinagar through Pahalgam 94 km by Bus, Chandanwari 16 km by walk **B**. Shri Parvat in Ladakh	Jammu and Kashmir	A. Throat B. Anklet	Mahamaya Devi	Trisandhyeshwar (Amarnath)	
2	Attahas Temple – At a village also named as Attahas or Ashtahas around 2 km east of Labhpur village road in the district of Birbhum	West Bengal	Lips	Phullara Devi	Vishveshwar	
3	Bahula Temple at Ketugram, 8 km from Katwa, Purba Bardhaman	West Bengal	Left arm	Goddess Bahuladevi	Bhirukeshwar[25]	
4	Bakreshwar, on the banks of Paaphara river, 24 km distance from Siuri Town [a district headquarter], district Birbhum, 7 km from Dubrajpur Rly. Station	West Bengal	Portion between the eyebrows	Mahishamardini devi	Vakranatheshwar	
5	Avanti, also known as Harsiddhi, at Bhairav hills on the banks of Shipra river in the city of Ujjaini.	Madhya Pradesh	Elbow	Avanti Devi	Lambkarneshwar	
6	Bhabanipur, located in the Upazila of Sherpur, Bogra, Rajshahi Division. Also located at Karatoyatat, it is about 28 km distance from the town of Sherpur.	Rajshahi Division, Bangladesh	Left anklet (ornament)	Aparna Devi	Vamaneshwar	
7	Biraja Temple at Jajpur, in Jajpur District	Odisha	Navel	Biraja Devi	Varaheshwar (Baraha)	
8	Mithila, near Janakpur	Nepal	Left shoulder	Uma Devi	Mahodareshwar	
9	Mahamaya Shakta pitha, at the confluence of the Vishnumati and Bagmati rivers in Kathmandu.[26]	Nepal	Both knees	Mahamaya[27]	Kapali	
10	Guhyeshwari Temple, near the bank of the Bagmati river, east of the Mrigasthali of the Pashupatinath temple.	Nepal	Anus[28][29]	Guhyakali	Pashupati	
11	Muktinath Temple[30]	Nepal	Head	Gandaki Chandi	Chakrapani	
12	Goddess Bhadrakali on banks of Godavari in Nashik city, Saptashrungi	Maharashtra	Chin (2 parts)	Bhadrakali devi	Vikritaksheshwar	
13	Hinglaj Mata Temple	Pakistan	Bramharandhra (Part of the head)	Kottari Devi	Bhimalochaneshwar	

14	Kalipeeth, (Kalighat, Kolkata)	West Bengal	Right toes	Kali Devi	Nakuleshwar	
15	Kamgiri, Kamakhya, in the Neelachal hills in Guwahati	Assam	Yoni	Kamakhya Devi	Umanandeshwar or Bhayanandeshwar	
16	Kankalitala, on the banks of Kopai River 10 km north-east of Bolpur station in Birbhum district, Devi locally known as Kankaleshwari	West Bengal	waist	Devgarbha Devi	Rurunatheshwar	
17	**A** Kanyashram of Balaambika – The Bhagavathy temple in Kanyakumari, the southernmost tip of mainland India, Tamil Nadu	Tamil Nadu	Back	Sarvani	Nimisheshwar	
18	Bajreshwari Mata Temple, Kangra	Himachal Pradesh	left Breast	Jayadurga Devi	Abhirunatheshwar	
19	Kiriteswari Temple at Kiritkona village, 3 km from Lalbag Court Road railway station in Murshidabad district	West Bengal	Crown	Vimala Devi	Sanvarteshwar	
20	Ratnavali, on the banks of Ratnakar river at Khanakul I Krishnanagar, district Hooghly (locally known as Anandamayee Tala)	West Bengal	Right Shoulder	Kumari Devi	Ghanteshwar	
21	Locally known as Trishrota/Bhramari Devi in Jalpaiguri near a small village Boda on the bank of river Teesta or Tri-shrota (combination of three flows) mentioned in Puranas	West Bengal	Left leg	Bhramari Devi	Ambareshwar	
22	Manas, under Tibet at the foot of Mount Kailash in Lake Manasarovar, a piece of Stone	China	Right hand	Dakshayani Devi	Amareshwar	
23	Ugratara Asthan	Bihar	Left Eye	Goddess Tara	Saharsa	
24	Manibandh, at Gayatri hills near Pushkar 11 km north-west of Ajmer. People know this temple as Chamunda Mata Temple or Shri Raj Rajeshwari Puruhuta Manivedic Shakta pitha.	Rajasthan	Wrists	Gayatri Devi	Sarvanandeshwar	
25	Nainativu (Manipallavam), Northern Province, Sri Lanka. Located 36 km from the ancient capital of the Jaffna kingdom, Nallur. The murti of the Goddess is believed to have been consecrated and worshipped by Indra. The protagonist, Lord Rama and antagonist, Ravana of the Sanskrit epic Ramayana have offered obeisances to the Goddess. Nāga and Garuda of the Sanskrit epic Mahabharata; resolved their longstanding feuds after worshipping this Goddess.	Sri Lanka	Silambu (Anklets)	Indrakshi (Nagapooshani / Bhuvaneshvari)	Rakshaseshwar (Nayanair)	

26	Jayanti at Nartiang village in the Jaintia Hills district. This Shakta pitha is locally known as the Nartiang Durga Temple.	Meghalaya	Left thigh	Jayanti Devi	Kramadishwar	
27	Jeshoreshwari Kali Temple	Bangladesh	Palms of hands and soles of the feet	Jashoreshwari	Chandeshwar	
28	Jwalamukhi Temple, Kangra from Pathankot alight at Jwalamukhi Road Station from there 20 km	Himachal Pradesh	Tongue	Jwalamukhi (Ambika)	Unmatta Bhairaveshwar	
29	Panchsagar Near Lohaghat (in Champawat District of Uttarakhand) just 12 km from nearest railway station Tanakpur. पूर्णागिरी Champawat Varahi Devi	Uttarakhand	Lower teeth/ Navel	Varahi Devi	Maharudra	
30	Near Somnath temple, Veraval, Gir Somnath district. Local People call this temple as Kali Mandir, It is nearby Triveni Sangam.[31]	Gujarat	Stomach	Chandrabhaga	Vakratundeshwar	
31	Alopi Devi Mandir near Sangam at Prayagraj	Uttar Pradesh	Finger	Lalita Devi	Bhaveshwar	
32	Present day Kurukshetra town or Thanesar ancient Sthaneshwar	Haryana	Ankle bone	Bhadrakali Devi	Sthanu	
33	Maa Sharda Mandir on top Trikoot Hill, at Maihar	Madhya Pradesh	necklace[32]	Shivani Devi	Chandeshwar	
34	Nandikeshwari Temple is located in Sainthia city	West Bengal	Necklace	Nandini	Nandikeshwar	
35	(Manikya Amba Shakta pitha / Bheemeswara Swami Temple) Draksharamam Kakinada	Andhra Pradesh	Navel	Manikyamba	Bheemeshwar	
36	Naina Devi Temple	Himachal Pradesh	Right eye	Mahishamardini Devi	Krodhishwar	
37	Shondesh/Shon/Maa Narmada temple, at the source point of Narmada River in Amarkantak	Madhya Pradesh	Right buttock	Narmada	Bhadraseneshwar	
38	Srisailam, at Nallamala hills, Andhra Pradesh	Andhra Pradesh, India	Neck	Bhramarambika Devi	Mallikarjuna	
39	Shuchi, in a Shiva temple at Suchindrum 11 km on Kanyakumari Trivandrum road	Tamil Nadu	Upper teeth	Narayani	Sihareshwar	
40	Sugandha, situated in Shikarpur, Gournadi, about 20 km from Barisal town, on the banks of Sonda river.8	Bangladesh	Nose	Sugandha	Trayambakeshwar	
41	Udaipur, Tripura, at the top of the hills known as Tripura Sundari temple near Radhakishorepur village, a little distance away from Udaipur town	Tripura	Right leg	Raja Rajeshwari Lalita Tripura Sundari (Third mahavidya) (main form of Parvati)	Tripureshwar	
42	Ujaani, at Mangalkot 16 km from Guskara station in Purba Bardhaman district	West Bengal	Right wrist	Mangal Chandika	Kapilambareshwar	
43	Varanasi at Manikarnika Ghat on banks of the	Uttar Pradesh	Earring	Vishalakshi Devi	Kala Bhairaveshwar	

	Ganges at Kashi					
44	Vibhash Shakta pitha, at Tamluk under district Purba Medinipur near river Rupnarayan	West Bengal	Left ankle	Kapalini Devi (Bhimarupa) also known as Bargabhima Devi	Sarvanandeshwar	
45	Ambika Shakta pitha, Virat Nagar district, Alwar, near Bharatpur, India	Rajasthan	Fingers of Left Leg	Ambika Devi	Amritaksheshwar	
46	Katyayani Shakta pitha, Vrindavan, district Mathura	Uttar Pradesh	Ringlets of hair	Uma Devi	Bhuteshwar	
47	Devi Talab Mandir, District Jalandhar	Punjab	Left Breast	Tripuramalini Devi	Bhishaneshwar	
48	Baidyanath Dham at Deoghar	Jharkhand	Heart	Jayadurga Devi	Baidyanath	
49	Adi Kamakshi Amman Temple behind Kamakshi Amman Temple, situated at Kanchipuram Town, Kanchipuram District	Tamil Nadu	Odyanam (Navel)	Kamakshi Devi (Elavarkuzhali)	Ekambareshwar	
50	Jogadya (যোগাদ্যা), at Kshirgram (ক্ষীরগ্রাম) near Kaichar under Burdwan district	West Bengal	Great toe	Jogadya Devi	Ksheerkantakeshwar	
51	Puruhutika Shakta pitha/Kukkutshwara Swamy Temple]] Kakinada Port Town	Peethapuram Andhra Pradesh	Hip part	Puruhutika	Durvaseshwar	
52	Arasuri Ambaji Shakta pitha at Gabbar Hill (Golden Temple of Gujarat)	Gujarat	Heart	Amba	Batuka Bhairava	
53	Danteshwari Temple, Dantewada	Chhattisgarh	Tooth	Danteshwari Devi	Kapala Bhairava	
54	Tara Tarini, Purushottampur, Ganjam	Odisha	Breast	Tara Tarini Devi	Tumbeshwar	
55	Nalhateswari, Nalhati	West Bengal	Stomach/Nauli	Kalika Devi	Jogeshwar	
56	Vimala Temple, Inside Jagannath Temple, Puri	Odisha	Foot	Vimala Devi	Jagannatheshwar	
57	Shankari Maha Shakta pitha, originally located in an unknown place in *Lanka*. This peetha is now associated by some with the city of Tricomalee.	Sri Lanka	Groin	Shankari Devi	Trikoneshwar	
58	Shri Mahalakshmi Griva Peeth, Shri Shail (also known as Mahalakshmi Griva pitha)	Gotatikar, Kalagul tea state, Dakshin Surma Upazila, Sylhet, Bangladesh	Neck	Mahalakshmi	Sambaranandeshwar	
59	Dhakeshwari Temple (now relocated at Dhakeswari Mata Temple) During the 1947 partition, Hindu temples were attacked and vandalised in Bangladesh (then East Pakistan) and West Pakistan, so the temple priest secretly bought the main idol of Dhakeshwari to Kolkata, West Bengal in India to a wealthy Bengali Hindu family and established a temple in Kumartoli. Now the descendants of the priest worship the idol in Kumartoli.	Dhaka, Bangladesh Currently in Kumartoli Kolkata, West Bengal	Gem of Sati's Crown	Dhakeshwari (a form of Katyayini Mahishasurmardini Durga)	Shiva	

60	Tarapith Rampurhat	West Bengal	Third eye	Maa Tara (second mahavidya) (main form of Parvati)	Chandrachuda Bhairava	
61	Chhinnamastika Shakta pitha at Chintpurni, Chintpurni of Himachal Pradesh	Himachal Pradesh	Foot	Chhinnamastika Devi	Rudra Mahadeva	
62	Kaali Mandir at Pavagarh hill in Panchmahal district with in Champaner Pavagadh Archaeological Park.	Gujarat	Right leg toe	Mahakali Devi	Batuka Bhairava	
63	Aranya Devi Mandir at Badi Devisthan Shish Mahal Chowk in Arrah.	Bihar	Right thigh[33]	Aranyani	Bhuma Bhairava	
64	Tuljabhavani Temple at Tuljapur, Dharashiv district	Maharashtra		Tuljabhavani Devi	Bhairava	
65	Mata Vaishno Devi Temple in Katra, Jammu	Jammu and Kashmir	Skull/Right arm[34]	Vaishno Devi	Bhairava Baba	
66	त्रिपुर सुंदरी मंदिर, बांसवाड़ा Maa Tripura Sundari Temple Vagad Shakta pitha Banswara Rajasthan Kuldevi of Panchal Community	Rajasthan		Goddess Tripura Sundari as Rajarajeshwari तरताई माता महालक्षमी महासरस्वती महादुर्गा जगतम्बा ।	Aanand Bhairava	
67	Chattal Bhawani Shakta pitha/Chandranath Temple	Chittagong-Bangladesh	upper teeth	Chattal Bhawani Devi	Chandrashekhar	
68	Jnanakshi Rajarajeshwari Temple	Bengaluru, Karnataka	Ear (Karnabhaga)[23][35]	Goddess Tripura Sundari as Rajarajeshwari	Abiru Bhairava	

Other Shakipeeths:-

The following shrines are not recognised as the Shakta pithas, but are still claimed by the devotees and priests, for various reasons.

1. Jwala Devi Temple in Jobner, Rajasthan, India

2. Jayanti Kali Temple (location disputed)

3. Asamai Devi Temple in Kabul, Afghanistan

4. Juranpur Kali Temple in West Bengal, India

5. Ambika Bhawani, Saran, Bihar (Yagyashala of Daksh)

5. Sarbamangala Temple in Burdwan, West Bengal (the temple priests claim that Goddess Sati's body part fell here)

6. Jogamaya Shakta pitha in Kalahandi, Odisha, India

There are disputes about the location of the Jayanti Shakta pitha. Based on most presented manuscripts and facts it is situated in the namesake Jaintiapur Upazila town, Bangladesh, which was previously the capital of the Jaintia Hills tribe kingdom, in the Jaintia Hills district of Meghalaya, India, excluding Jaintiapur. However, some believe that the Nartiang Durga Temple is the true Jayanti Shakta pitha, although historical evidence supporting this claim is limited. Some other people[36] argue the actual shrine is at Amta in West Bengal, where the goddess is worshiped as *Maa Melai Chandi* in Melai Chandi Mandir. But this fact can not be corroborated with any evidence. Moreover, refuting most texts, in Melai Chandi Mandir, the Bhairava is *Durgeshwar* rather than *Kramadishwar*. Some also identify the Jayanti shrine with the Mahakal cave temple situated in the village Jayanti of Alipurduar in India,[37][38] where many statues were created by Stalagmites and Stalactites (natural rock formations), but there is no evidence.

Vindhyavasini Shakta pitha

The Vindhyavasini Shakta pitha is considered a Shakta pitha even though any body parts of Sati did not fall there. Vindhyavasini is the ultimate and the highest form of the goddess, she is called Adi Parashakti. Goddess Vindhyavasini is considered the embodiment of all of the Mahavidyas, Navadurgas, Matrikas, Yoginis and all the other goddesses present in this universe, she is Tripura Sundari herself. Many legends are associated with Vindhyavasini, she is also called Mahadurga. She is the combined form of all 108 Shakta pithas as mentioned in the Devi Bhagavata Purana text. This is because it is the place where the goddess chose to reside after her birth in Dvapara Yuga.[39] At the time of the birth of Krishna to Devaki and Vasudeva, Vindhyavasini took birth in Gokula to Nanda and Yashoda as per the instruction of Lord Vishnu. Vasudeva replaced his son Krishna with this girl child of Yashoda so that Krishna could escape his demon uncle Kamsa, whom he would kill later according to a prophecy. When Kamsa tried to kill the girl, she slipped from his hands, assumed her true form and warned Kamsa that his killer (Krishna) still lived on. She left Mathura and the goddess chose the Vindhya Mountains as her abode to live on the earth. It is also believed that Vindhyavasini is the sister of Krishna.[39]

See also

- Hindu pilgrimage (yatra)
- Hindu pilgrimage sites
- List of Hindu temples
- List of Mansa Devi temples

Further reading

- Dineschandra Sircar (1998). *The Śākta Pīṭhas* (https://books.google.com/books?id=I969qn5fpvcC). Motilal Banarsidass Publ. ISBN 978-81-208-0879-9.

Notes

a. Also known as Durga

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External links

- 52 Shakta pithas map (http://www.shaktipeethas.org/51-shakti-peethas-map-t11.html) Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20081113120138/http://www.shaktipeethas.org/51-shakti-peethas-map-t11.html) 2008-11-13 at the Wayback Machine
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